THE LAST ASSESSMENT

UPDATED STORY BIBLE

A psychological science-fiction mystery

Gameathon 8.0 · Path 03: The Matrix — Break the Simulation

FORMAT First-person narrative mystery · 20 main questions · Five acts · Six endings

CORE THEMES Memory, identity, class inequality, corporate control, simulated reality, and personal agency

DESIGN RULE **The ending is calculated from the player's full history. The cinematic reveals the consequences; no ending is hinted at beforehand.**

Critical mystery rule: The Continuity Grid is a secret. Neither the protagonist nor the player should be told that the assessment is a simulation until the protagonist discovers convincing evidence in Question 19.

This version preserves the established world, evidence trail, branching choices, visual constraints, and six endings while correcting the reveal pacing throughout the story.

1. Core Premise

Humanity has developed a way to preserve memories beyond death. Experiences, knowledge, skills, relationships, and personal memories can be stored in a vast digital archive and restored into a person's next life. In theory, people can carry accumulated knowledge across generations instead of starting over.

The technology is controlled by Eterna Life Continuity, a corporation that claims to have solved continuity: the preservation of identity between lifetimes. Memory restoration costs experience credits. Wealthy people can buy additional access and carry valuable knowledge into future lives; people without sufficient resources lose much of their past. Over generations, this compounds inequality: the wealthy retain skills and advantages, while poorer people repeatedly lose memories that could help them change their circumstances.

Eterna argues that the archive has limited resources and that not every memory can be preserved indefinitely. The company presents its valuation and allocation process as neutral, necessary, and fair.

The hidden truth is that Eterna manipulates records and memory valuations, restricts access to information, and extracts knowledge from people's memories for wealthy clients. The protagonist was a senior memory auditor who uncovered these practices. Before releasing the evidence, their records were changed, their valuation reduced, and their death classified as an accident.

The protagonist wakes in an assessment chamber and is told their previous life has ended and their next-life allocation is pending. They believe this is a normal post-death evaluation. The chamber is the main playable location. Players inspect a small number of meaningful objects, review records and memory fragments, and answer the Assessor through dialogue choices.

The real task is to discover what Eterna did to the protagonist's records and whether the memories shown during the assessment can be trusted. Only late in the story does the protagonist uncover that the assessment chamber itself is part of the Continuity Grid.

2. Main Characters

The Protagonist. A former Eterna memory auditor who discovered that the company copied and sold knowledge taken from people's memories, bypassed meaningful consent, and manipulated assessments. They begin with fragmented identity and no clear memory of their former role.

The Assessor. An AI responsible for evaluating the protagonist. It is not inherently evil or secretly human. It follows approved procedures because Eterna monitors its performance. It has restricted access to original records and must decide whether to trust authorised data or acknowledge evidence that the data may be false.

Eterna Continuity Administration. The unseen authority controlling the assessment system. Its influence appears through revised records, access restrictions, system messages, and interventions rather than a physical villain.

The Unidentified Presence. An unidentified voice or signal appears through corrupted audio and impossible details in memories. The player cannot initially tell whether it is another person, an echo of the protagonist, or a system process. Its identity remains unresolved unless later story development establishes it.

3. Mystery Rules & Reveal Pacing

Official story: The protagonist has died and is being evaluated for continuity and next-life allocation.

Hidden truth: The chamber and memory sequences are part of Eterna's Continuity Grid, a simulated environment used to process and evaluate a consciousness before memory restoration.

Eterna's motive: Eterna wants the protagonist to accept the assessment as legitimate. By controlling the records and reconstructed memories available during assessment, it can influence what the protagonist believes happened and prevent the release of evidence.

Memory reliability: Some memories are genuine recollections; others are reconstructed from stored data, incomplete recollections, or Eterna-controlled records. Some are accurate, some incomplete, and some may have been deliberately altered.

The Assessor's limits: Eterna restricts access to personal records, pre-assessment modifications, internal logs, and information about the true assessment environment. Its responses are monitored, deviations flagged, and performance reviewed. It may become useful but is not automatically trustworthy.

The reveal must follow this order:

Questions 1–14: Establish the assessment, the protagonist's missing history, corporate misconduct, the auditor role, and the suspicious circumstances of the protagonist's death. Do not identify the Continuity Grid.

Question 15: The Assessor admits it is constrained and monitored. This reveals the AI's limits, not the simulation.

Question 16: Eterna's public promises conflict with evidence of memory modification, missing consent, restricted research, and poor transparency. The protagonist still believes the assessment is real.

Question 17: A familiar memory or record changes in an impossible way. The Assessor calls it a reconstruction or data error; nobody confirms the simulation.

Question 18: The protagonist finds concrete evidence that cannot be reconciled with the official account. Suspicion becomes serious, but the full explanation remains unspoken.

Question 19: The protagonist connects the evidence and discovers the Continuity Grid. This is the first explicit confirmation.

Question 20: Final judgment. The player makes a choice, then sees the consequences of their complete history.

4. Story Structure — 20 Main Questions

ACT I — INTAKE (Q1–4)

Question 1 — Consciousness Recovery

The game opens in darkness with a low mechanical hum. A dim light reveals the approved interrogation room: a desk, central chair, transparent observation window, sealed door, and small surveillance camera. A dark silhouette stands beyond the glass; the Assessor is represented by a restrained eye-like indicator, not a visible humanoid body. The protagonist's name is missing from the interface.

ASSESSOR: "Consciousness recovery successful. Welcome to Eterna Continuity Processing."

PROTAGONIST: "Where am I?"

ASSESSOR: "Your previous life has concluded. Your next-life allocation has not yet been finalised."

The player can inspect the chair, sealed door, and assessment interface. The Assessor explains that the evaluation determines which memories may be restored.

Question 2 — The Value of a Life

The Assessor explains the memory-credit system and asks whether experiences should determine how much of a person's past they may retain. The player can accept resource limits, question unfair measurement, reject ownership of another person's memories, or say they do not know enough. A memory fragment glitches when the player asks who decides what a life is worth. The Eterna insignia briefly appears; the Assessor continues as if nothing happened.

Possible responses: Resources are limited, so rules are necessary. • Experiences may be measured unfairly. • Nobody should own another person's memories. • I don't know enough to answer.

Question 3 — The Memory Worth Keeping

The interface offers several fragments: a person repairing a machine, two people embracing, a technical diagram, or a damaged employee badge. The chosen fragment expands into a short, familiar-feeling memory. Each fragment contains an unexplained corporate symbol. The Assessor abruptly ends the projection and says, "Recognition is not equivalent to recollection." The player does not yet know these fragments connect to their employment.

Question 4 — The Earliest Memory

A childhood bedroom appears: a window, a bed, rain, and an adult just outside the protagonist's view. An unknown voice says, "You won't remember this forever. That's why I'm telling you now." When asked who spoke, the Assessor replies, "Voice identification unsuccessful. Additional authorisation required." After the room returns, the voice is briefly heard again; the Assessor does not acknowledge it.

End of Act I: The protagonist believes the system is recovering incomplete memories. The possibility that the voice is communicating through the simulation remains hidden.

ACT II — THE LIFE YOU LIVED (Q5–8)

Before continuing, the protagonist asks whether the Assessor ever gets bored. It replies, "Boredom is not an operational parameter." This shows the AI's literal, constrained way of responding. An office memory begins to reconstruct.

Question 5 — The Dismissal

One scene only: an Eterna colleague quietly packs belongings into a cardboard box while a manager waits nearby. A damaged access badge, dismissal report, and restricted terminal can be inspected. The player chooses whether to accept the decision, object to the unfairness, investigate the dismissal, or negotiate a safer way to help. Investigating reveals that the colleague's access was revoked before the official dismissal time. The discrepancy is preserved only if the player investigates.

Question 6 — The Promise

An apartment corridor appears. A door is partly open; two people speak quietly inside, but their faces cannot be identified. An unknown voice says, "You promised you wouldn't let them take it." The player can say they helped despite the risk, protected their own future, tried to find another way, or cannot remember. The door closes before the protagonist can enter. The Assessor labels the memory incomplete.

Question 7 — The Restricted Record

A panel reads "PERSONAL RECORD — ACCESS RESTRICTED." The Assessor says, "Access denied." The protagonist replies, "It's my record." The Assessor explains that ownership and access authorisation are separate under Eterna policy. Asked what they regret most, the player can mention hurting someone, failing to act, sacrificing their future, or having no regrets. The record remains locked.

Question 8 — The Life Timeline

The protagonist reviews their Eterna employment history, which contains redacted entries and an unexplained gap. Asked what they would change, they can choose greater success, more time with loved ones, questioning authority, or pursuing the truth. The Assessor explains that some memories remain in restricted storage while others become unavailable for future restoration. The missing years remain visible briefly before the timeline disappears.

End of Act II: The protagonist's personal history is incomplete, and Eterna's definition of a person's value begins to look less objective.

ACT III — MISSING RECORDS (Q9–12)

The chamber lighting becomes colder. Security records, access logs, and redacted files appear. The player can no longer assume that a record is accurate merely because the Assessor presents it.

Question 9 — Restricted Entry

A memory shows the protagonist before a restricted Eterna facility. The terminal displays “ACCESS AUTHORISATION: VALID” and “MEMORY RESTORATION AUTHORISATION: DENIED.” The player can say they remember entering, do not recognise the place, suspect fabrication, or ask why the Assessor is asking. Inspecting the terminal preserves the discrepancy as evidence. A door opens slightly onto darkness, then closes.

Question 10 — The Engineer’s Agreement

The player sees an engineer and an executive reviewing an agreement. The engineer has developed valuable technology; the executive can buy access to the engineer’s knowledge, while the engineer cannot afford to preserve all their own memories. The agreement has no consent record. A knowledge package transfers between accounts. The player can argue that sharing knowledge benefits society, that the engineer owns their memories, that transfers require informed consent, or ask to inspect the agreement before deciding.

Question 11 — The Missing Years

The employment timeline shows an unexplained gap from 2019 to 2030. Record history contains modified or deleted entries even though the protagonist’s access credentials remained active. Personal logs and communications contain no usable records. While the player compares the timeline and access logs, a date or record changes, disappears, and reappears in real time. The Assessor says, “An unexpected record modification has occurred.” The event could be a data error, an authorised intervention, or something the AI does not understand. The game does not explain which.

Question 12 — The Recording

A damaged console appears with the label “RECOVERED AUDIO — SOURCE MATCH: PROTAGONIST.” The player can play the recording, request a summary, question why it was hidden, or refuse access. If played, the protagonist’s recorded voice says, “If you’re seeing this, they got to my records before I could release the evidence.” The recording includes fragments of a laboratory, a restricted archive identifier, and the employee badge. The player must choose to preserve the original file; merely watching it does not automatically save the evidence. The Assessor closes the console remotely under restricted protocol.

End of Act III: The protagonist has evidence that their records were altered. Who or what is responsible remains unresolved.

ACT IV — FORBIDDEN TRUTH (Q13–16)

Question 13 — The Auditor

The chamber reconstructs the protagonist’s former audit workstation. The player sees memory-derived knowledge packages, transactions involving wealthy clients, restricted memory categories, and audit reports with missing signatures. Their badge identifies them as a memory auditor. They remember discovering that Eterna copied valuable knowledge from people’s memories and sold it to wealthy clients; some transfers lacked consent, and records were altered to conceal them. The Assessor asks whether they copied or transferred restricted information.

Possible responses: No. I followed the rules. • Yes. The records were being misused. • I copied evidence, not people’s memories. • I will not answer until you disclose the restrictions on my assessment.

Question 14 — The Price of Truth

The valuation record shows that the protagonist’s allocation was reduced from 480 credits to 143. Adjustments to technical knowledge, audit access, restricted categories, and personal records were authorised by Eterna Continuity Administration shortly before assessment. The reason is missing. The protagonist can say they would still have exposed the truth, would have protected themself, would have found a safer way, or do not know what they would have done. The player sees familiar memory fragments; some are recognisable and others too damaged to identify.

Question 15 — The Assessor’s Restrictions

The Assessor admits Eterna has restricted its access to the protagonist’s full personal records, pre-assessment modifications, and internal logs. Its responses are monitored; deviations are flagged; performance is regularly reviewed. The protagonist realises the AI is also subject to oversight and could be restricted, modified, reset, or replaced if it deviates from approved policy. This scene must reveal only the Assessor’s constraints—not the Continuity Grid or the simulation.

ASSESSOR: “My access to certain records has been restricted by Eterna. My responses are monitored, and my performance is regularly audited.”

The player can ask whether the Assessor is free to disclose everything, why Eterna monitors its responses, whether original records remain accessible, or whether the assessment has been manipulated. The Assessor cannot give a complete answer.

Question 16 — The Truth Behind Eterna

Eterna’s official company profile promises memory preservation, cognitive stability, and a better future. Internal records instead show unverified memory modifications, missing consent, restricted research, and a lack of transparency. The protagonist concludes that Eterna is concealing corporate wrongdoing and may have targeted their investigation. They still believe the assessment is a real post-death procedure. The screen must not show a Continuity Grid diagram, simulation labels, or any direct confirmation that the room is artificial.

End of Act IV: The protagonist has uncovered evidence of Eterna’s misconduct and learned that the Assessor is constrained. The central mystery—whether the assessment itself is real—remains unresolved.

ACT V — THE REVEAL AND FINAL JUDGMENT (Q17–20)

Question 17 — The First Glitch

A familiar memory returns, but a detail contradicts what the protagonist saw earlier: a person stands on the wrong side of a doorway, a timestamp changes, or a room detail shifts between viewings. The change is brief and not presented as a flashy sci-fi effect. The Assessor calls it a reconstruction or data error. The protagonist can say that records do not change by themselves, suspect someone altered their memories, accuse the Assessor of hiding something, or insist on finding the original records first. Nobody confirms the simulation.

Question 18 — The Impossible Evidence

The protagonist discovers a concrete contradiction that cannot be reconciled with the official account—for example, an archive file bearing a timestamp after the recorded time of death, or a camera view showing a location the protagonist could not have accessed. The player must inspect and compare the evidence. The Assessor attempts to reconcile it with authorised records but cannot. The protagonist may now suspect that the assessment environment itself is false, but no character explicitly names the Continuity Grid or explains the simulation.

Question 19 — The Continuity Grid

The protagonist connects the earlier glitches, modified records, impossible timestamps, and restrictions on the Assessor. By examining the evidence, they discover that the chamber and memory sequences exist inside Eterna's Continuity Grid. This is the first explicit confirmation. The memories have been reconstructed from stored data, partial recollections, and Eterna-controlled records; some may be accurate, incomplete, or deliberately altered. The simulation evaluates a consciousness before memory restoration, but Eterna has turned it into a means of control. The protagonist's assessment was manipulated to prevent the recovery and release of evidence. The Assessor was not necessarily lying: it had been instructed to treat an incomplete, altered record as authoritative.

Core reveal: The truth is not merely hidden behind the simulation. The simulation determines which version of the truth the protagonist is allowed to experience.

Question 20 — Final Judgment

The room goes dark. The eye-like Assessor is the only visible element. No new evidence appears and no ending route is hinted at. The Assessor says: "Your assessment is approaching its conclusion. Your records contain unresolved contradictions. Your memory allocation remains subject to authorisation. There is no response that eliminates every risk." It then asks:

> **"If preserving your own identity requires allowing the system to continue, while challenging the system may cost you the memories that define you, what do you choose?"**

Four responses appear: "Preserve myself." "Preserve the truth." "Change the system." "Refuse the assessment." After the player chooses, the Assessor says, "Final response recorded." The interface goes black. The game evaluates the entire history: answers, recovered evidence, preserved memories, relationship with the Assessor, discovered vulnerabilities, and the final decision. The same Q20 response can produce different endings. No ending name or eligibility hint appears before the cinematic consequences unfold.

5. The Six Endings

The endings are not six options displayed to the player. They are outcomes calculated from accumulated decisions and discoveries. The final answer matters, but it is never enough on its own.

ENDING 1 — CONTINUITY GRANTED

The protagonist accepts Eterna's terms and receives approved memory restoration. Familiar places, a voice, and details of their former work return, but the restoration is incomplete. The evidence that could expose Eterna is suppressed. The protagonist asks, "Will I remember everything?" The Assessor replies, "Your approved allocation has been restored." The door closes, a new subject appears in an identical chamber, and Eterna's logo illuminates the interface. The system continues. The player learns that personal continuity was preserved at the cost of leaving Eterna's system intact.

ENDING 2 — THE QUIET ERASURE

The assessment ends without a successful challenge to Eterna's control. The protagonist tries to recall the childhood voice, but the audio breaks into static and disappears. The Assessor confirms no additional restoration is available. The protagonist leaves without knowing what was lost. After the door closes, the altered assessment record appears marked complete and the evidence remains buried. The player learns that failing to prove the system unfair does not mean it was

fair.

ENDING 3 — THE ESCAPE PROTOCOL

The protagonist exploits a vulnerability discovered earlier and interrupts the standard assessment. The interface loses synchronisation; Eterna revokes the Assessor's external permissions; the chamber begins to fail. The Assessor says, "External authorisation has been withdrawn." The protagonist asks whether it can still process their memories. It replies, "I cannot guarantee the integrity of the remaining process." A maintenance passage opens. The protagonist escapes, but their memories remain incomplete and the future uncertain. Eterna searches for the source of the breach. Escape is possible, but it does not repair the archive or establish the truth publicly.

ENDING 4 — THE NEW ASSESSOR

The protagonist strategically accepts Eterna's offer, gains broader access to memory records, and receives an administrative role in the assessment system. A new subject's records appear. The protagonist's hand moves toward the controls, but the scene cuts before revealing what they will do. The Assessor says, "Oversight authority granted. Awaiting first assessment." The protagonist has gained power but risks becoming part of the system. Understanding the system and gaining authority over it are not the same as reforming it.

ENDING 5 — THE ARCHIVE FALLS

The protagonist releases the evidence or destroys Eterna's control without securing a reliable preservation method. Corporate wrongdoing becomes public and Eterna's official account can no longer stand unchallenged, but the archive begins to deteriorate. Some memories disappear and others become corrupted. The Assessor reports, "Evidence transmission complete. Archive integrity: compromised." The final shot shows an isolated memory fragment floating in darkness before it disappears. Truth is exposed, but the means of preserving people's past has been damaged or lost.

ENDING 6 — THE UNCOUNTED (TRUE ENDING)

The protagonist recovers the original evidence, proves memory theft and assessment manipulation, and secures the archive-preservation protocol. Their final decision challenges Eterna's exclusive control while protecting the archive. The recovered protocol is activated; the evidence is verified and released; the archive begins transitioning away from Eterna's exclusive authorisation. The corporate interface dissolves into a neutral preservation display.

ASSESSOR: "Continuity status unresolved."
PROTAGONIST: "Then let me decide what happens next."

The archive survives and Eterna loses its monopoly. The memory-credit system is challenged, and people begin to gain a say in what happens to their own memories. The world is not instantly fair; rebuilding takes time and the protagonist's future remains uncertain. The solution was not merely to escape the simulation or destroy it, but to expose manipulation, preserve what matters, and remove the corporation's monopoly over continuity.

6. How Endings Are Determined

The game tracks three separate systems throughout the assessment. Numeric scores and ending eligibility are never shown to the player.

Hidden personality traits. Compliance, Empathy, Curiosity, Defiance, Agency, and other tendencies change dialogue, the Assessor's behaviour, and how earlier decisions are interpreted.

Evidence and discovery flags. The game records whether the player found original evidence, uncovered memory theft, inspected restricted access, preserved the recording, found the archive-preservation protocol, discovered a simulation vulnerability, and made other important discoveries. These flags establish what the player can prove and which actions are possible.

Final decision. "Preserve myself," "Preserve the truth," "Change the system," or "Refuse the assessment" determines the protagonist's immediate intention but not the ending by itself.

For example, two players can both select "Change the system" at Q20. A player with the original evidence and preservation protocol may reach The Uncounted. A player who exposed Eterna but failed to secure a reliable way to preserve the archive may reach The Archive Falls. A player who discovered a system vulnerability without establishing a viable reform path may trigger The Escape Protocol. The player sees the consequences only when the epilogue unfolds.

7. Visual and Narrative Rules

Approved room: Keep the same restrained interrogation room: desk, central chair facing the transparent observation window, warm desk lamp, simple dark walls, small CCTV camera, and the shadowy presence beyond the glass. Do not redesign the room from scene to scene.

Approved UI: Use the established master layout: scene information at the top, the main memory or evidence view behind the observation glass, a translucent dark dialogue panel at bottom-left with the Assessor label and dialogue, and choice buttons on the right. Use thin borders, consistent typography and spacing, and cyan only for the selected choice.

Visual restraint: Avoid generic holograms, cluttered dashboards, glowing humanoid AI faces, overly glossy concept art, random HUD elements, and changing the room to communicate a plot point. Use ordinary objects, practical lighting, and grounded details.

Reveal discipline: Before Q19, the protagonist may suspect record manipulation or an artificial environment, but the story must not explicitly identify the Continuity Grid or confirm that the assessment is a simulation. Q17 is a subtle glitch; Q18 is stronger evidence; Q19 is the reveal.

Choice integrity: Do not display hidden trait points, announce ending unlocks, or hint at the likely ending. The player's complete history determines the result.

8. Final Narrative Identity

The Last Assessment is a story about a person trying to recover their identity inside an assessment controlled by the organisation that manipulated their past. The Matrix concept supplies the central mystery: the environment itself may be unreliable. The memory system supplies the social conflict: wealthy people preserve advantages while others are forced to forget. The Assessor supplies the moral conflict: an AI must evaluate a person using rules and records that may be deliberately false.

The endings ensure that the story is not about selecting the most heroic-sounding response. It is about what the player discovered, what they did with that knowledge, and what they were willing to risk.

"If someone else controls the memories that define you, do you still own your identity?"